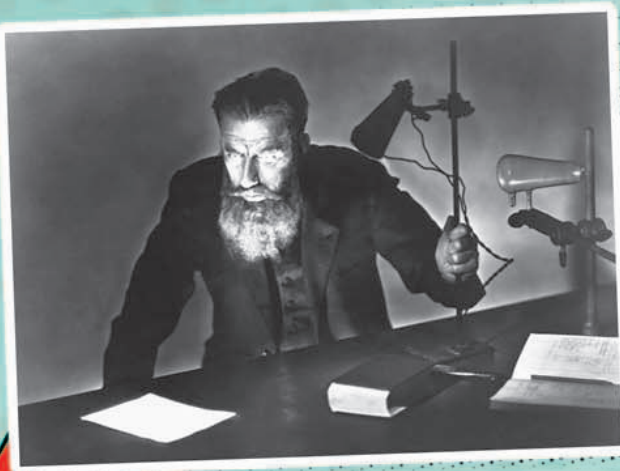


The earliest known surgery was performed as early as 10,000 BCE



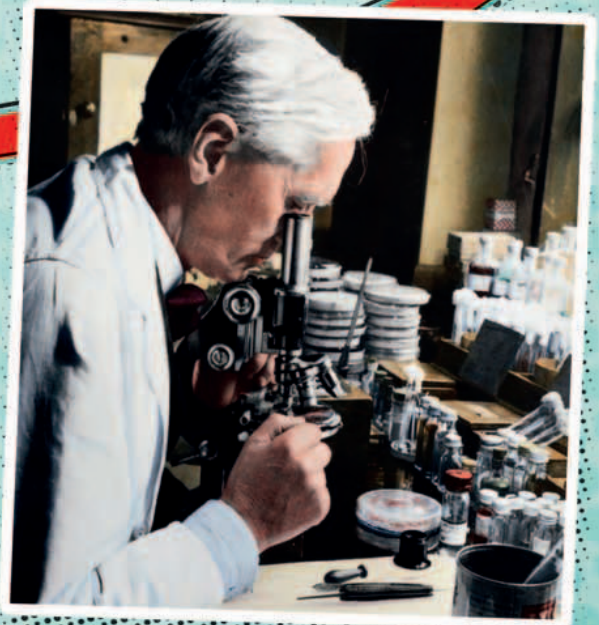
Joseph Lister (1827–1912)

In the 19th century, lots of people died after surgery. Lister was a British doctor who believed that this was because **germs** from **dirty equipment** and unwashed hands were infecting patients during an operation. He came up with the idea of sterilizing equipment and treating wounds with **ANTISEPTICS**, substances that prevent the growth of disease-creating microorganisms. Sterilization worked and, as a result, less people died after surgery.



Wilhelm Roentgen (1845–1923)

When the German physicist Wilhelm Roentgen was experimenting with passing electric currents through gases, he noticed something **very strange**. He had produced a mysterious form of radiation that seemed to pass through objects. Uncertain what he was dealing with, he called his discovery **X-RAYS**. Today, X-rays are used in medicine to **detect** everything from broken bones to various forms of cancer.



Alexander Fleming (1881–1955)

This Scottish doctor was growing bacteria on petri dishes when he noticed that some dishes had grown **moldy**. Before he threw out the dishes, he noticed that the mold seemed to have **killed** the bacteria he was growing. He called the substance **PENICILLIN**, and it was the very first antibiotic.

In 1816, the first stethoscope was made of rolled-up paper. Later it became a wooden tube.

